which had linked its present and future indissolubly and forever with the country of Lenin and the other states of the socialist community.'

The new preamble stated:

In pursuance of the revolutionary traditions of the German working class and based on the liberation from fascism, the people of the GDR have, in agreement with the process of the historical development of our epoch, realised its right to socioeconomic, state and national self-determination and is shaping the developed socialist society.

The preamble had previously said that the people of the GDR, 'led by the responsibility to show the entire German nation the road to a future of peace and socialism', had given itself this socialist Constitution. The newly formulated passage that the GDR is a socialist state of workers and peasants, previously read that the GDR was a 'socialist state of the German nation'.

In clause 8, a passage was deleted that spoke of the 'overcoming of the division of Germany forced by imperialism upon the German nation', as well as of the 'bringing together step by step of the two German states until their unification on the basis of democracy and socialism'. In the new sections, it was underlined that the GDR was 'an inseparable component of the socialist community of states'. Furthermore, the status of the State Council, the Council of Ministers and the Presidium of the People's Chamber was defined and partially strengthened through the amendment of the Constitution.